

HSBC "Immersive Online Assessment" — Candidate Briefing

Contents

How to read this briefing

Executive summary (one page)

Vendor & provenance (Phase 1)

1. Who builds and hosts it
2. Multiple vendors across stages — the nuance a single-vendor answer misses
3. Date-stamping & obsolescence (Phase 1 item 3)

Q1 — STRUCTURE (every stage, in order)

Full application sequence

Inside the immersive assessment

Timing, navigation, device

Business lines & regions (Phase 1 item 2)

Q2 — CONTENT (what each section actually contains)

Two distinct stages — sources conflate them

Stage 1 — section by section

Stage 2 — the four micro-exercises

Values the SJT is scored against

Q3 — SCORING AND RANKING (the priority)

The vendor's philosophy dictates the logic

How each item type is scored

Cut score, percentile, ranked list?

Weighting, carry-forward, human review, benchmarking

Why the strengths logic matters for scoring

Q4 — THE MODEL UNDERNEATH

HSBC's current values framework (what the behavioural items score against)

Mapping each section to the traits it probes (the reasoning, not an answer key)

Q5 — WHAT SEPARATES PASSES FROM FAILS

Common failure patterns

Time-management traps

Underestimated sections

Consistency, and extreme vs moderate responses

Retake / reapplication policy & cooling-off

Q6 — INTEGRITY & MONITORING (framed for an honest candidate)

What HSBC's own Privacy Notice establishes

What Cappfinity markets (integrity features)

Monitored behaviour → honest-candidate accidental trigger → how to avoid it

What the terms prohibit — and the consequences

Q7 — LEGITIMATE PREPARATION

Most faithful to the real thing (start here)

Paid third-party packs

Free resources

Honest relevance verdict

Verbatim candidate reports

What I could NOT verify (read this)

Source list (grouped by reliability)

Tier 1 — Official primary (HSBC & the vendor)

Tier 2 — Industry / prep guides (secondary; commercial bias; corroborate on format)

Tier 3 — General reference (mechanism, not HSBC-specific)

Tier 4 — Genuine candidate voice (gated; snippet-only or unopened)

Prepared: 8 August 2026 · **For:** a candidate preparing legitimately · **Scope:** HSBC graduate / early-careers / experienced-hire early-stage online assessment(s).

This is an evidence-based briefing, not an answer key. Every claim carries a reliability label (see *How to read this briefing*). Where sources disagree, the disagreement is shown rather than resolved silently. Where something could not be verified, that is stated plainly.

Golden rule that falls out of the research: the assessment is a **strengths-based** instrument that cross-checks your answers for authenticity and consistency, plus a **hard cognitive filter** where accuracy matters. The winning strategy is *be accurate on the data questions and genuinely, consistently yourself on the behavioural ones* — not to perform an "ideal banker." This is a research conclusion, not motivational filler; the mechanism is explained in §3–§5.

How to read this briefing

Reliability labels (applied to every substantive claim):

- **OFFICIAL** — stated by HSBC or the assessment vendor in a primary source.
- **CORROBORATED** — three or more independent candidate/industry sources agree.
- **ANECDOTAL** — a single or weak/second-hand source.
- **INFERRED** — my reasoning from the available evidence; not a documented fact.

A sourcing limitation you must weigh. The richest candidate-voice sources — **Reddit, The Student Room, Wall Street Oasis, Glassdoor, YouTube comments** — were **blocked (HTTP 403 / login / captcha)** to the research tooling. Almost all readable detail therefore comes from **commercial prep-site guides**, which reconstruct the test and frequently copy one another. Treat prep-site "example questions" as **INFERRED approximations, not verbatim candidate memory**, and treat prep-site agreement as weaker evidence than the raw count suggests. The strongest primary anchors in this briefing are HSBC's own 2024–2025 transcripts and Applicant Privacy Notice, and Cappfinity's own 2024 methodology whitepaper.

Citations are numbered **[n]** and resolve to the **Source list** at the end.

Executive summary (one page)

- **Vendor.** The immersive assessment is built for HSBC by **Cappfinity** (formerly Capp / Capp & Co; a UK strengths-assessment firm founded 2005) — **CORROBORATED** across 8+ industry sources [\[15\]](#)[\[18\]](#)[\[21\]](#)[\[23\]](#)[\[25\]](#)[\[29\]](#)[\[31\]](#)[\[33\]](#). **Caveat:** no HSBC or Cappfinity primary source that could be read actually *names* HSBC as a Cappfinity client — the attribution is well-corroborated second-hand but **not first-party confirmed** [\[9\]](#)[\[8\]](#). The later **video "Job Simulation"** stage is variously attributed to **Cappfinity or HireVue** — genuinely disputed [\[18\]](#)[\[32\]](#).
- **Shape of the process.** **OFFICIAL** HSBC runs three stages: (1) online application form (~10–15 min); (2) **online assessment(s)** — "one or two stages", each "around 40 minutes", inside a ~90-minute slot; (3) assessment centre (~3 hours; "Super Day" in the US) — replaced by an online interview for insight/work-experience programmes [\[1\]](#)[\[2\]](#).
- **The immersive assessment itself.** **CORROBORATED** ~38 questions across 5 scenario-linked sections, delivered as clickable "tiles" that unlock sequentially; ~16 cognitive (numerical / verbal / inductive) + ~22 situational-judgement / personality items; **officially untimed but ~50 minutes** in practice; SJT items are **ranked 1–5** [\[15\]](#)[\[21\]](#)[\[23\]](#)[\[25\]](#). Exact section names and counts are **single-source and cycle-dependent** — do not over-index on them.
- **Scoring.** **OFFICIAL** Cappfinity is strengths-based: it scores whether your *authentic, energising pattern of behaviour* fits the role, not whether you picked a "correct" personality answer [\[7\]](#). **CORROBORATED** Cognitive items are **right/wrong, benchmarked against a graduate norm group**, and behave as a **hard filter**; SJT/strengths items are **profile-matched** against HSBC's values with "no single right answer"; **time taken is recorded and factored in** even though the test is "untimed" [\[19\]](#)[\[29\]](#)[\[35\]](#). **The exact cut score and weighting are proprietary and undisclosed — a real, verified gap.**
- **The model underneath.** **CORROBORATED** The behavioural items map to HSBC's **four current values: We value difference · We succeed together · We take responsibility · We get it done** [\[38\]](#). Some prep pages still cite the **obsolete pre-2021 triad "Open / Connected / Dependable"** — a dated-source disagreement to ignore [\[30\]](#)[\[35\]](#).
- **What separates passes from fails.** **CORROBORATED** as a **pattern** Numerical/data errors are the classic killer; faking a "perfect" values profile backfires because strengths are cross-probed for consistency; the cognitive sections are the ones candidates underestimate [\[19\]](#)[\[33\]](#)[\[35\]](#).
- **Integrity.** **OFFICIAL** Cappfinity markets integrity features — **Camera-On Assessment, Copy Prevention, Time-Recorded Assessment, and an Integrity Dashboard that flags likely AI use** [\[10\]](#). **OFFICIAL** HSBC's Applicant Privacy Notice records video answers, may use them in decisions, uses automated decisioning (with a right to human review), and warns that detected malpractice can lead to refusal of employment; results are retained 12 months [\[5\]](#). For an honest candidate the risk is *accidental* flags — covered in §6 with how to avoid each.

- **Preparation.** **OFFICIAL** The most faithful practice is Cappfinity's own demo and Preparation Hub, plus HSBC's post-application Candidate Hub ^{[11][12]}. Paid HSBC-specific packs (JobTestPrep, Graduates First) help most on the SJT/strengths/video dimension; generic aptitude packs (Practice Aptitude Tests, Preterminal's SHL/Hogan course) help only on numerical/verbal speed ^{[15][28][18][36]}. See the separate **prep-plan.md** for a two-week schedule.

Vendor & provenance (Phase 1)

1. Who builds and hosts it

- **CORROBORATED** The immersive assessment vendor is **Cappfinity** — named independently by JobTestPrep, Practice Aptitude Tests, AssessmentCentreHQ, AptitudePrep, TestSolve, GraduatesFirst, AssessmentDay and Intervyo ^{[15][18][21][23][25][29][31][33]}.
- **INFERRED** / **important caveat** The attribution is **not confirmed by any first-party source that could be read**. HSBC's own materials describe the assessment generically ("immersive experiences", "real-life scenarios") and **never name a vendor** ^{[1][2][3]}. Cappfinity's own website is JavaScript-rendered and did not return readable body text, so its client list could not be checked at source ^{[9][8]}. The "HSBC is a Cappfinity client" claim reaches this briefing only second-hand (e.g. Intervyo lists HSBC among Cappfinity clients) ^[33].
- **OFFICIAL** — **vendor product identity** Cappfinity does market an **"immersive" / VR work-preview product line**, consistent with the "immersive assessment" branding ^[13].

2. Multiple vendors across stages — the nuance a single-vendor answer misses

Stage	Vendor claimed	Confidence
Immersive assessment (cognitive + SJT + strengths)	Cappfinity	CORROBORATED ^{[15][21][23][25]}
Video "Job Simulation"	HireVue or Cappfinity	DISPUTED — HireVue per ^{[18][32]} ; Cappfinity per ^[15]
"Values Assessment" (older framing)	SHL	ANECDOTAL — single source ^[22]

- **INFERRED** Most likely current reading: the immersive cognitive/SJT stage is **Cappfinity**; the recorded-video interview is **HireVue**; the "SHL Values Assessment" attribution is probably a **stale**

carry-over from HSBC's pre-2023 process.

- **CORROBORATED** Arctic Shores, Amberjack and Pymetrics — no evidence links any of them to HSBC's current process (Arctic Shores is KPMG's game-based test). SHL / Kenexa belong to HSBC's older process.

3. Date-stamping & obsolescence (Phase 1 item 3)

- **Current process (Cappfinity immersive):** consolidated ~2023–2026; this is what 2025–2026 sources describe and is reliable for a 2026 applicant.
- **Legacy process (pre-~2023):** standalone SHL numerical/verbal + SJT, HireVue video, Kenexa. Any source describing "separate SHL numerical and verbal tests" as the first stage is describing the obsolete process.
- The 2018 HSBC "Hints and tips" PDF is ~8 years old — **obsolete** [4]. Many prep pages are auto-stamped "2026/2027" for SEO while the underlying detail is 2023–2025 vintage; the one clearly outdated prep guide flagged here (Practice Reasoning Tests) was last updated Nov 2023 [30].
Best anchors: HSBC's Dec 2024 / Jan 2025 transcripts and current careers site [1][2][3].

Q1 — STRUCTURE (every stage, in order)

Full application sequence

CORROBORATED, reconciling official + prep:

1. **Online application form** — CV/transcripts; **OFFICIAL** "~10–15 mins"; no long written questions [1].
2. **Online Immersive Assessment** — cognitive + SJT + strengths (detail below).
3. **Job Simulation / video interview** — present for *some* roles (HSBC's "one or two stages") and tailored to your business area [2][15].
4. **Assessment Centre** — **OFFICIAL** "~3 hours", mostly virtual, called "**Super Days**" in the US; replaced by an online interview for insight / work-experience programmes [1][2].

Inside the immersive assessment

- **OFFICIAL** HSBC: the online assessment slot is **90 minutes**; it contains "audio or video content, mock emails, data tables and graphs, or written articles" and requires "short written and video responses"; "**takes around 40 minutes to complete**" and there may be "**one or two stages**" depending on the role [1][2].

- **CORROBORATED** Prep-site consensus: **38 questions total** = **~16 cognitive** (numerical, verbal, inductive) + **~22 SJT / personality-values**; "officially untimed" but **~50 minutes** expected [15][21][23][25].
- **ANECDOTAL** — **single detailed source** Five named sections. **Two naming conventions circulate** (probably different cycles or just paraphrase); both are shown because sources genuinely disagree:

#	Naming set A (JobTestPrep, TestSolve)	Naming set B (AssessmentCentreHQ, AptitudePrep, Practice4Me)	Content	Items
1	Project Kick-Off	Creating a New Team	SJT — form a team, set standards	4 SJT
2	Global Engagement	Working with Others	SJT — collaboration / conflict across roles & cultures	4 SJT
3	Data Monitoring	Communicating Globally	Cognitive + SJT on 5–6 data sources	10 (8 cog + 2 SJT)
4	Navigating Competing Commitments	Competing Commitments	Cognitive + SJT — juggling side projects	9 or 10 (disagreement)
5	Pause and Reflect	Completing the Project Delivery	SJT + personality — deadlines, errors, prioritisation	11

Sources: [15][21][23][25][26][31]. **DISAGREEMENT** on total count 38 (dominant) [15] vs "~40 MCQs" (GraduatesFirst) [28] vs "26 questions total" (a Student Room candidate, ~2019, **likely obsolete**) [43].

Timing, navigation, device

- **CORROBORATED** Timing is **overall, not per-question**, for the immersive part; officially untimed but ~40–50 min expected [1][15][23].
- **ANECDOTAL** Sub-tests **unlock sequentially**; you can **skip and review/revise within a sub-test before submitting it, but not after** submitting a section [15].
- **CORROBORATED** The **video "Job Simulation" IS per-question timed**: ~15 items across ~4 micro-exercises, ~35–50 min total; **~30 sec–2 min prep**, **~2 min record** per question; no live

interviewer; **no re-record once started**; a free-text email task capped at ~2,500–3,000 characters [15][16][20][27]. **DISAGREEMENT** on video timing "2 min prep / 2 min record" (most) [16][20] vs "30 sec prep / 3 min answer" (TestSolve) [25].

- **CORROBORATED** **Device**: webcam + microphone required for the video stage; quiet room; pen & paper recommended; a **physical/handheld calculator is permitted** for the numerical section [15][32]. No formal OS/browser spec surfaced.
- **CORROBORATED** **Total end-to-end**: application ~10–15 min; immersive ~40–50 min; job simulation ~15–50 min; assessment centre ~3 hrs.

Business lines & regions (Phase 1 item 2)

- **OFFICIAL** HSBC uses **one common early-careers framework** across programmes and states assessments are "**tailored to the business area** you are interested in" — but publishes no per-line or per-region breakdown [1].
- **INFERRED** The **same Cappfinity platform** is used across GBM (Global Banking & Markets) / Wealth & Personal Banking / Commercial / Technology, with **scenario content tailored** and the values/cognitive core held constant. No source shows GBM using a *different vendor or fundamentally different structure* at the immersive stage; line-specific differences concentrate **later** (technical interviews at the assessment centre; GBM/Markets-Tech front-office roles carry heavier technical interviewing).
- **UNVERIFIED** **UK vs Hong Kong vs elsewhere**: no direct evidence the immersive assessment differs by region. The only confirmed regional variation is **terminology and later-stage logistics** (US = "Super Days"). Whether HSBC Asia uses an identical Cappfinity instance, a localised version, or a different provider is **not documented** — treat as unknown, not "the same". (Note: "HSBC immersive" web searches also surface an unrelated private-banking client "Tech Immersive Tour" in Asia — not a recruitment assessment; do not conflate.)

Q2 — CONTENT (what each section actually contains)

All concrete "examples" below are **prep-site reconstructions** **INFERRED**, not verbatim candidate memory, unless explicitly marked as a candidate quote. They illustrate *format and flavour*, not questions you will see.

Two distinct stages — sources conflate them

- **Stage 1 — Online Immersive Assessment (Cappfinity):** the ~38-question, tile-based, mixed cognitive + SJT test; **generic**, not business-area-specific. **CORROBORATED** [15][21][25]
- **Stage 2 — Job Simulation (HireVue/Cappfinity video):** shorter, ~15 items, recorded **video** answers + a **written email** task, **tailored to your business area**; reached only after passing Stage 1. **CORROBORATED** [15][20][27]

Because the terms "immersive assessment", "job simulation", "simulation game" and "virtual experience" are used interchangeably, when reading any single report **check whether it describes video answers (Stage 2) or ranking tiles (Stage 1).**

Stage 1 — section by section

- **SJT sections (Project Kick-Off / Global Engagement, etc.).** **CORROBORATED** Present a workplace scenario, then ask you to **rank 5 options 1–5** (drag-and-drop; 1 = most likely, 5 = least likely) [21][23][30].
- **INFERRED** example, *AptitudePrep* "While you have been diligently working on a project for several weeks, **Kieran**, a new member who recently joined HSBC, has brought forward other suggestions and identified flaws in your work" → "How do you incorporate Kieran's feedback?" → rank 1–5 [23].
- **INFERRED** example, *AptitudePrep* A team feedback session on displaying client-brochure findings in an app; "only some colleagues are actively participating"; options include "Actively asking quieter members questions to encourage contribution" [24].
- **Cognitive sections (Data Monitoring / Competing Commitments).** **CORROBORATED** Multiple-choice numerical/verbal reasoning drawn from **5–6 information tabs** (tables, graphs, pie charts, an email) [15][25].
- **INFERRED** example, *JobTestPrep* analyse NGO subscriber data across months → "Which of the following NGOs had the second-highest percentage increase in subscribers?" [15].
- **INFERRED**, *TestSolve* each cognitive item bundles roughly "1 table chart, 2 graphs, 1 pie chart, and an email from a colleague"; question shapes like "Which region showed the largest percentage decline in Q3?" [25].
- **Personality / work-style (Pause and Reflect).** **CORROBORATED** Forced-choice **preference scales** — e.g. a slider between "I support on small elements of a variety of tasks" and "I see a task through to completion" [23]. This feeds the strengths/trait profile and the consistency check (see §3, §5).

Stage 2 — the four micro-exercises

INFERRED structure, **CORROBORATED** that it exists ^{[15][16][20][27][30]}.

1. **Video set-up** — one practice video question (e.g. "introduce yourself" / "your biggest strength"); framed as an unassessed connection test (**but prep sites warn to treat every item as assessed** ^[15]).
2. **SJT on a fictitious news article** — e.g. an article about an event (a "G7 Summit" example is cited); video + 1–5 ranking; tests "approach to commencing a research project."
3. **Fictitious company analysis** — ~6 items, personality + SJT.
4. **Further analysis / email task** — ~6 items, video + SJT + a **free-text email reply** (≤ ~3,000 chars) — "respond to an email or report as if you're already on the job." *This 3,000-character email is the single most consistently repeated concrete detail across sources.*

Values the SJT is scored against

- **CORROBORATED** Current SJT rubric = HSBC's four values (see §4). Some sources cite the older triad "Dependable / Open / Connected" — **likely obsolete** ^{[26][30]}. (A 2019 candidate advised mentioning "dependable" as a keyword — see verbatim quotes; this reflects the old values and may no longer apply.)

Q3 — SCORING AND RANKING (the priority)

Up-front verified gap: Cappfinity treats its scoring algorithm as proprietary. **No source — official or otherwise — discloses the actual cut score, section weightings, or trait-inference formula.** Everything about *mechanism* below is either Cappfinity's published *philosophy* **OFFICIAL** or industry *inference* about how it is operationalised **INFERRED** / **CORROBORATED**.

The vendor's philosophy dictates the logic

- **OFFICIAL** From Cappfinity's 2024 whitepaper *The Scientific Origins of Skills & Strengths* (Edition 8): a strength is "a pre-existing capacity for a particular way of behaving, thinking or feeling that is **authentic and energizing** to the user"; the assessment measures "two or more of the three dimensions of **performance, motivation and use**" ^[7]. **The scored construct is not "did you pick the correct answer" — it is "does your natural, energising behaviour match what the role rewards."**
- **OFFICIAL** Cappfinity explicitly rejects the competency "big-bucket" model ("a descent into mediocrity") in favour of its **80-skill set**, and states "**every Cappfinity skill has been**

benchmarked against workplace performance over multiple years", using a "Futuremark" / "Success Analysis" method that profiles what success looks like in a role and scores candidates against it — i.e. **criterion validation against the client's own success profile** [7][8].

How each item type is scored

Item type	Scoring logic	Confidence
Numerical / Verbal (cognitive)	Right/wrong, objective , benchmarked against a graduate/professional norm group ; no negative marking; unanswered = 0; often adaptive .	CORROBORATED [19] [28][35]
Situational Judgement	Ranked/rated (drag 5 options 1–5), scored against HSBC's behavioural/values model — " no single correct answer ", but responses closer to the desired pattern score higher. Best described as behaviourally-anchored + partially ipsative .	CORROBORATED [23] [30][35]
Personality profiling	Self-report preference scales feeding algorithmic trait inference into the strengths profile.	CORROBORATED [15] [20]
Time taken	Time-factored — "untimed" but the time you take " is taken into account " alongside accuracy; speed can break ties.	CORROBORATED [19] [29]; tie-break effect INFERRED

Cut score, percentile, ranked list?

- CORROBORATED** The **cognitive component is norm-referenced** (percentile vs a graduate norm group) — you compete against other graduates, not an absolute bar [35].
- ANECDOTAL** // **INFERRED** The **behavioural/strengths component is profile-matched** against the role/intake benchmark: "the same answers can fit one route, such as audit or advisory, better than another" [33].
- VERIFIED GAP** The **exact numeric cut score is not published anywhere**.
- ANECDOTAL** — **folklore, treat as such** Widely repeated but unverifiable figures: only ~10% clear the online gate; HSBC's overall offer rate ~3% [35][43].

Weighting, carry-forward, human review, benchmarking

- ANECDOTAL** Weighting is undisclosed, but the mechanism implies **cognitive accuracy acts as a hard filter** while strengths/values shape fit ("weak data interpretation can hold back an otherwise strong profile") [33].

- **INFERRED** / **weak** Whether the score **numerically carries forward** is unconfirmed; the immersive stage is best understood as a **gate**, with later stages separately assessed. (Results are *retained* 12 months for reuse across applications — a data-retention fact, not evidence of a rolling score [5].)
- **CORROBORATED** **Human review**: the immersive stage is **machine-scored**; human assessors enter later — the Job Simulation free-text/video and the assessment centre are **human-reviewed** [15][20]. HSBC confirms automated decisioning is used, **with a right to human review** [5].
- **OFFICIAL** that the method exists; **INFERRED for HSBC specifically** Cappfinity's Futuremark method is *designed* to benchmark against a client's high performers; that HSBC specifically ran it on its own top performers is plausible but **not independently verified** [7].

Why the strengths logic matters for scoring

- **CORROBORATED** as **philosophy** Because the same strengths are probed repeatedly in different forms, **coherence is scored, not just content**: "inconsistent or exaggerated answers stand out. A coherent, authentic profile scores better than one that swings around to chase an ideal candidate" [33]. This is the *mechanical* reason that trying to "give HSBC what it wants" backfires.

Q4 — THE MODEL UNDERNEATH

HSBC's current values framework (what the behavioural items score against)

CORROBORATED HSBC's four current values (adopted ~2021, current as of 2026) [38]:

1. **We value difference** — empathy for diversity; actively seek views different from your own; inclusive.
 2. **We succeed together** — trust, support and connect with others; collaborate across boundaries.
 3. **We take responsibility** — high standards, accountability, good judgement, speaking up.
 4. **We get it done** — move steadily toward goals, continuously improve, make clear decisive choices.
- **DISAGREEMENT** to **flag** Several 2026 prep pages still describe the **older triad "Open / Connected / Dependable"** (HSBC's pre-2021 values) — **treat as obsolete**; prepare around the current four [30][35].

- **OUTLIER** — do not rely on One site describes an **OPQ32 / SHL "Great 8"** forced-choice model with "Most/Least" ranking [37]. That is inconsistent with a Cappfinity strengths assessment and probably describes HSBC's older SHL-era test or a conflation.

Mapping each section to the traits it probes (the reasoning, not an answer key)

Section	Item mix	Competency / value it probes — why
Project Kick-Off / Creating a Team	SJT	<i>We succeed together</i> + <i>We get it done</i> — mobilising a team and setting direction
Global Engagement / Working with Others	SJT	<i>We value difference</i> + <i>We succeed together</i> — cross-cultural collaboration and conflict handling
Data Monitoring	Cognitive + SJT	Cognitive rigour + <i>We take responsibility</i> — accurate judgement under ambiguity
Navigating Competing Commitments	Cognitive + SJT	Prioritisation + <i>We get it done</i> — trade-offs under constraint
Pause and Reflect	SJT + personality	Self-awareness + values coherence — feeds the trait/strengths profile and the consistency check

CORROBORATED The **Job Simulation** probes the same four values plus **communication and prioritisation under a realistic work scenario**, and is partly human-reviewed [15][20]. **INFERRED**

The strengths quadrant Cappfinity uses (performance × energy × use) means it is trying to distinguish *realised strengths* (you're good at it **and** it energises you) from *learned behaviours* (good at it but draining) — which is why authenticity, not just competence, is being measured [39].

Q5 — WHAT SEPARATES PASSES FROM FAILS

Common failure patterns

- **CORROBORATED** as a pattern; underlying reports **second-hand Numerical/data errors are the classic killer** — misreading units, percentage-change slips, rushing data interpretation. The recurring (forum-sourced) warning: "you can't make numerical mistakes as you'll be rejected", while SJT is "more flexible" [43][19][35].

- **CORROBORATED** On verbal items, **over-using "Cannot Say" and importing outside knowledge** instead of reasoning strictly from the passage [35].
- **CORROBORATED** as philosophy **Faking a values profile** — because strengths are cross-probed, an incoherent "ideal candidate" performance is detectable and scores *worse* than an authentic one [33].
- **ANECDOTAL** Treating the **set-up/practice video as "not counted"** — prep sites warn every item may be assessed [15].

Time-management traps

- **CORROBORATED** The test is "untimed" **but time is recorded and factored in** — over-deliberating on every item can disadvantage you, and speed breaks ties at equal accuracy. Cited pacing: budget ~50 min; ~80 s per numerical item, ~45–50 s per verbal item [19][35].
- **ANECDOTAL** **Review-before-submit is per-subtest only** — don't submit a section prematurely [15].

Underestimated sections

- **INFERRED** + **CORROBORATED** The **cognitive/data sections** are underestimated because the branding is "immersive/behavioural" — yet accuracy there is what most often ends applications; candidates report **speed** as the hardest aspect [19].
- **INFERRED** The **personality/consistency layer** is dismissed as "just a personality quiz" when it materially shapes the strengths-fit score.

Consistency, and extreme vs moderate responses

- **CORROBORATED** as philosophy **Consistency matters and is measured** — cross-probing of the same strengths means an internally consistent, authentic profile scores better than a self-contradictory or exaggerated one [33].
- **INFERRED** — **general SJT literature, not an HSBC rule** Be **decisive and honest, not performatively extreme**: committing clearly to genuine best/worst rankings beats fence-sitting, but artificially maxing every "desirable" trait ("extreme responding") is a known red flag that consistency checks catch [40][41]. **VERIFIED GAP** No HSBC-specific rule on extreme-vs-moderate is published.

Retake / reapplication policy & cooling-off

- **CORROBORATED** **No retake within the same application cycle** for underperformance — only genuine, documented **technical** failures reported within ~24–48 h are re-issued [33][35].

- **ANECDOTAL** / **CORROBORATED** You may **reapply in the next intake cycle**, and "your previous result does not appear on future applications" ^[35].
- **ANECDOTAL** / **INFERRED** — **explicit gap Cooling-off**: no official HSBC number is published. Generic industry guidance cited is **~6 months minimum, up to 12 months**; one HSBC-specific anecdote mentioned ~6 months (for a customer-consultant, not graduate, role). **Treat 6–12 months as an estimate and verify with HSBC graduate recruitment** ^[34].

Q6 — INTEGRITY & MONITORING (framed for an honest candidate)

Purpose: so an honest candidate understands the rules and avoids **accidental** flags. Nothing here describes how to defeat detection. Where a monitored behaviour is listed, the "avoid" advice is about *not tripping a system while behaving normally*, not evasion.

Context. **INFERRED** from take-home format; **CORROBORATED** it is take-home The immersive assessment is best understood as an **unproctored, deadline-based take-home** test (a link, "a set number of days", completed unsupervised) — *except* for the recorded **video** question(s), which use your webcam ^{[15][20]}.

What HSBC's own Privacy Notice establishes **OFFICIAL** ^[5]

- Records "video chats" and "may use these recordings to make decisions on the outcome of your application."
- "May capture additional information about ... the **devices or software that you use**"; uses cookies and similar technologies.
- Uses **automated systems** in decisions, **with a right to request human review**.
- Processes data to detect "**fraud, other unlawful or dishonest conduct, malpractice, and other seriously improper conduct**"; verbatim consequence: "**If any of these are detected, you could be refused certain services or employment.**"
- "May pass information to relevant agencies if we think you've given us **false or inaccurate information.**"
- Assessment **results are retained 12 months** and reused for future HSBC applications.

What Cappfinity markets (integrity features)

OFFICIAL that the features exist; **ANECDOTAL** // **INFERRED** for their mechanics — the feature pages are JavaScript-rendered and could not be read in full [\[10\]](#).

Named features: **Camera-On Assessment**, **Copy Prevention**, **Time-Recorded Assessment**, **Integrity Dashboard** (which surfaces flags to recruiters and "highlights behaviour indicative of AI model use"), and **Image Assessment Stimuli**. **NOT VERIFIED** whether HSBC switches Camera-On on for the graduate immersive specifically, or whether it is periodic capture vs continuous recording.

Monitored behaviour → honest-candidate accidental trigger → how to avoid it

Monitored	How an honest candidate could accidentally trigger it	How to avoid it
Webcam / Camera-On (video answers) [10] [5]	Being off-camera, poorly lit, another person visible/audible; repeatedly looking off-screen (reading notes) can read as external help	Sit alone in a quiet, well-lit room; face the camera; speak to camera (glancing at the on-screen question is fine); run the built-in video set-up first [15]
Copy-paste / tab-switch detection (Copy Prevention, Integrity Dashboard) [10]	Opening another tab to check a definition or a calculator app ; pasting text drafted elsewhere into a free-text box; notification pop-ups stealing focus	Use only on-screen tools; keep a physical calculator on the desk (permitted) rather than an app/tab [32] ; type answers directly ; close other apps and silence notifications
Response-latency / time recording (Time-Recorded Assessment) [10] [19]	Answering <i>implausibly fast</i> (complex numerical items in seconds); very long uneven gaps from walking away mid-question	Work at a genuine, steady pace; complete each section in one focused sitting; take breaks <i>between</i> sections. There is no penalty for taking sensible time — don't rush into errors to look "fast"
IP / device fingerprinting [5]	Using a VPN/proxy/Tor (mismatched or datacentre IP looks evasive); switching devices/networks midway; shared/public Wi-Fi another applicant used	Use your normal home connection without a VPN ; stay on one device on one network start to finish
Social-desirability / consistency scales (embedded in personality/SJT) INFERRED	Giving the "ideal banker" answer to everything → an all-perfect, internally inconsistent profile these scales are built to catch; rushing paired items into contradictions	Answer honestly and consistently ; read each item; pick what genuinely reflects you
AI / plagiarism detection (Integrity Dashboard "highlights AI use") [10]	Free-text that reads as AI-generated (generic, over-polished, boilerplate) can be flagged even if you wrote it ; reading a scripted answer verbatim to camera looks like external prompting	Write in your own natural voice with specific personal examples; speak from bullet notes , not a full script

What the terms prohibit — and the consequences

- **OFFICIAL** / **CORROBORATED** Commonly prohibited: **third-party help / impersonation, using AI tools where disallowed, recording / screenshotting / transcribing content, and sharing or reproducing questions**. Cappfinity keeps an **integrity record**; flags can affect future assessments/roles ^[10].
- **OFFICIAL** Detected malpractice can lead to **refusal of employment** and information being passed to relevant agencies ^[5].
- **INFERRED** — **read this yourself** The **exact, binding rules for your sitting are on the pre-assessment instruction screen and the declaration/consent box you tick before you start**. A standalone HSBC "assessment honour code" page could not be found; the Applicant Privacy Notice is the strongest official document that could be fully read ^[5].

Q7 — LEGITIMATE PREPARATION

Most faithful to the real thing (start here)

Resource	Link	Cost	Honest relevance
Cappfinity official demo	practice.cappassessments.com	Free demo	OFFICIAL Same <i>engine/interface</i> as the real tests (numerical/verbal/critical-reasoning demos). Best for the question UI ; limited breadth
Cappfinity Preparation Hub / Preparation Plus	hub.preparationplus.com	Free (vendor)	OFFICIAL Prep from the actual test vendor; closest match to real format
HSBC Candidate Hub	(unlocked after you apply)	Free	CORROBORATED — claim HSBC reportedly gives applicants tailored tips/practice once you've applied — check it first ^[3]

INFERRED No public official practice test appears to exist *before* application; official practice sits inside the Candidate Hub / Cappfinity demo.

Paid third-party packs

Provider	Link	Price (as seen)	Honest relevance
JobTestPrep	HSBC immersive pack	Not displayed (1/3/6-mo sub; geo-gated)	ANECDOTAL HSBC-specific pack simulating the 5 sections; reasonably targeted but claims are self-made, no independent calibration
Graduates First	HSBC tests	Not shown; money-back-if-you-don't-pass	ANECDOTAL Covers verbal/numerical/logical + SJT + video interview + AC — the video/strengths coverage makes it more relevant than pure aptitude; used by many UK universities
Practice Aptitude Tests	HSBC profile	"Pro" sub (not shown); some free samples	ANECDOTAL Explicit disclaimer that its tests are "not designed to be identical to any employer" — generic aptitude drills ; good for numerical/verbal speed, weak on the immersive feel
Prepterminal	HSBC course	\$68 / 90 days	OFFICIAL price SHL/Hogan-based video course; makes no Cappfinity claim ; least tailored to the immersive

Free resources

- ANECDOTAL** Fintest (free via sign-up; good stage breakdown, dated May 2024) ^[32]; Psychometric Success (free guide, Nov 2024) ^[20]; AptitudePrep (free sample cognitive + SJT, Jun 2025) ^[23]. **Flag:** Practice Reasoning Tests is dated Nov 2023 — possibly obsolete ^[30].
- INFERRED** University careers services and YouTube walkthroughs are useful for **strengths-interview and video-answer practice**, but are not HSBC-calibrated.

Honest relevance verdict

- Most faithful:** Cappfinity demo + Preparation Hub, then HSBC's Candidate Hub ^{[11][12]}.
- Good for the strengths/SJT/video dimension:** Graduates First and JobTestPrep's HSBC packs ^{[28][15]}.
- Generic aptitude value only:** Practice Aptitude Tests, Prepterminal (SHL/Hogan) ^{[18][36]}.
- INFERRED** **Biggest gap across almost all packs:** thin coverage of the **video/immersive simulation** itself — so **practise recording yourself answering timed prompts**, which no aptitude pack replicates well.

(A concrete day-by-day schedule is in the separate `prep-plan.md`.)

Verbatim candidate reports

Only **two genuine candidate-voice fragments** could be recovered — both via search-engine snippets, because the underlying pages returned 403 / login walls. Everything else circulating as "candidate questions" on prep sites is reconstruction, not memory.

▼ Verbatim candidate report — ANECDOTAL— Glassdoor candidate, via search snippet; date not visible, page login

ANECDOTAL — Glassdoor candidate, via search snippet; date not visible, page login-gated; ref QTN_6902278 ^[42] "The Online Immersive Assessment consist of behavioural questions which ask you to rank your actions in the given situations and math questions ask you to questions with the given datas and graphs."

ANECDOTAL — The Student Room "Hsbc immersive test" (thread t=5603334), via search snippet; older thread ~2019, **POSSIBLY OBSOLETE** ^[43] "The Immersive Online Assessment is a combination of situational judgment questions and numerical questions based on data sources provided, with 26 questions in total. Only 10% of applicants pass as competition is extremely high. You can't make numerical mistakes as you'll be rejected. Situational judgment questions are more flexible. You should mention key values such as 'dependable', otherwise you may automatically fail as software catches the 'keywords'." *Caveat: the "26 questions" count and the "dependable" keyword advice conflict with 2025–26 descriptions (current values dropped "dependable") and may be out of date.*

Unopened but relevant candidate threads (403/login-gated to the tooling — a human can open them directly): The Student Room t=6707088 ("HSBC Job Simulation 2021"), t=6156362, t=6709852; Wall Street Oasis "HSBC Job Simulation"; Glassdoor HSBC interview hub; YouTube "2025 HSBC Online Immersive Assessment... Exact Questions" (watch?v=9zthcTo0Xbg) ^[44]^[45]^[46]^[47]^[42]^[48].

What I could NOT verify (read this)

1. **Vendor at first-party level.** Cappfinity is well-corroborated by industry sources but **no readable HSBC/Cappfinity primary source names HSBC as a client** [\[9\]](#).
2. **Which vendor runs the video "Job Simulation"** — Cappfinity vs HireVue is genuinely disputed [\[18\]](#)[\[32\]](#).
3. **Exact scoring internals** — cut score, section weightings, trait-inference algorithm: **proprietary and undisclosed everywhere** [\[7\]](#)[\[21\]](#).
4. **Whether HSBC ran concurrent validation on its own high performers** — the method exists; HSBC-specific calibration is not documented [\[7\]](#).
5. **Whether the immersive score numerically carries into later stages** — unconfirmed; likely a gate [\[5\]](#).
6. **Exact HSBC cooling-off period** for graduate reapplication — 6–12 months is an estimate, not confirmed policy [\[34\]](#).
7. **Precise ipsative-vs-keyed implementation of the SJT** — described as ranked/profile-matched, exact method unpublished.
8. **Exact section names/counts** — single-source and cycle-dependent (38 vs ~40 vs 26; section 4 = 9 or 10) [\[15\]](#)[\[28\]](#)[\[43\]](#).
9. **Whether HSBC enables Camera-On / continuous proctoring for the grad immersive**, and Cappfinity's exact IP/device-fingerprinting and consistency-scale behaviour — feature *existence* is official, mechanics are not [\[10\]](#).
10. **A standalone HSBC assessment terms/honour-code page** — not found; rely on the on-screen declaration before your sitting [\[5\]](#).
11. **Regional variants (esp. Hong Kong/Asia)** — undocumented; unknown, not "identical."

Paywalled / gated and therefore not verified: HSBC's live Candidate Hub / Practice Zone (login) [\[6\]](#); Cappfinity marketing/integrity-feature page bodies (JavaScript-rendered) [\[9\]](#)[\[10\]](#); Capp help-desk device-requirements article (403) [\[14\]](#); Glassdoor, Wall Street Oasis, The Student Room threads, Reddit, YouTube comments (403 / login / captcha) [\[42\]](#)[\[43\]](#)[\[47\]](#); JobTestPrep / Graduates First / Practice Aptitude Tests prices (geo-gated).

Source list (grouped by reliability)

Tier 1 — Official primary (HSBC & the vendor)

1. HSBC Careers — Students & Graduates *Application guide* (current, 2026) — <https://www.hsbc.com/careers/students-and-graduates/application-guide>
2. HSBC — *The application process* video transcript (PDF, 3 Jan 2025) — <https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/careers/students-and-graduates/pdf/250103-the-application-process-transcript.pdf>
3. HSBC — *HSBC Assessments: Supporting Your Application* transcript (PDF, 18 Dec 2024) — <https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/careers/students-and-graduates/pdf/241218-hsbc-assessment-supporting-your-application-transcript.pdf>
4. HSBC — *Hints and tips: Internships and graduate assessments* transcript (PDF, 2018 — **OBSOLETE**) — <https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/media-gallery/transcripts/181020-hsbc-how-to-transcript.pdf>
5. HSBC — *Applicant Privacy Notice* (PDF; generic/RESTRICTED; companion version last updated 1 Jan 2025) — <https://www.hsbc.com/appendices/ApplicantPrivacyNotice-Generic.pdf>
6. HSBC — Candidate portal (login-gated, not accessible) — <https://apply.careers.hsbc.com/>
7. Cappfinity — *The Scientific Origins of Skills & Strengths*, Edition 8 (PDF, 2024) — https://files.strengthsprofile.com/Deployable/LocalizableResources/en-gb/Resources/Edition8CappfinitySkillsSeries-ScientificOriginasofSkillsandStrengths_UK.pdf
8. Cappfinity — Skills & Strengths Assessment product page — <https://cappfinity.com/solutions/for-talent-leaders/assessments/skills-strengths-assessment/>
9. Cappfinity — homepage (JavaScript-rendered; body not readable) — <https://www.cappfinity.com/>
10. Cappfinity — Integrity Features hub + sub-pages (Camera-On / Copy Prevention / Time-Recorded / Integrity Dashboard; existence confirmed, bodies not readable) — <https://cappfinity.com/integrity-features/>
11. Cappfinity — official practice / demo — <https://practice.cappassessments.com/>
12. Cappfinity — Preparation Hub / Preparation Plus FAQs — <https://hub.preparationplus.com/faqs>
13. Cappfinity — PR: "transforms Gen Z hiring with VR & immersive work previews" (2022) — <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/cappfinity-transforms-gen-z-hiring-with-virtual-reality-and-immersive-work-previews-301559721.html>
14. Capp Help Desk — Device Requirements for Online Assessments (HTTP 403, not readable) — <https://capphelpdesk.zendesk.com/hc/en-us/articles/25465900866589-Device-Requirements-for-Online-Assessments>

Tier 2 — Industry / prep guides (secondary; commercial bias; corroborate on format)

15. JobTestPrep — HSBC Online Immersive Assessment (2026) — <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-online-immersive-assessment>
16. JobTestPrep — HSBC Assessment Centre / Job Simulation (2026) — <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-assessment-centre>
17. JobTestPrep — HSBC practice tests hub — <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/hsbc-practice-tests>
18. Practice Aptitude Tests — HSBC assessments (upd Mar 2025; Job Sim = HireVue) — <https://www.practiceaptitudetests.com/top-employer-profiles/hsbc-assessments/>
19. Practice Aptitude Tests — Cappfinity publisher page (algorithmic + time-factored) — <https://www.practiceaptitudetests.com/testing-publishers/cappfinity/>
20. Psychometric Success — HSBC Online Job Simulation (Nov 2024) — <https://psychometrics.com/aptitude-tests/test-types/hsbc-online-job-simulation>
21. AssessmentCentreHQ — HSBC Online Immersive test (2026) — <https://www.assessmentcentrehq.com/hsbc-online-immersive-test/>
22. AssessmentCentreHQ — HSBC Job Simulation (outlier: Cappfinity + SHL) — <https://www.assessmentcentrehq.com/hsbc-job-simulation-assessment/>
23. AptitudePrep — HSBC Immersive Online Assessment (Jun 2025) — <https://www.apptitudeprep.com/hsbc-immersive-online-assessment/>
24. AptitudePrep — HSBC Simulate assessment — <https://www.apptitudeprep.com/hsbc-simulate-assessment/>
25. TestSolve — HSBC (2026) — <https://www.testsolve.ai/companies/hsbc/>
26. Practice4Me — HSBC assessment tests (2026) — <https://www.practice4me.com/hsbc-assessment-tests/>
27. GraduatesFirst — HSBC Job Simulation — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/hsbc-job-simulation>
28. GraduatesFirst — HSBC assessment tests (upd May 2026) — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/hsbc-assessment-tests>
29. GraduatesFirst — Cappfinity publisher guide (upd Jan 2026) — <https://www.graduatesfirst.com/aptitude-tests-publishers/cappfinity>
30. Practice Reasoning Tests — HSBC Online Job Simulation (upd Nov 2023 — **possibly obsolete**; uses old values) — <https://www.practicereasoningtests.com/hsbc-online-job-simulation-assessment>
31. AssessmentDay — HSBC Online Immersive Assessment (2026) — <https://www.assessmentday.co.uk/profiles/hsbc-online-immersive-assessment.html>

- 32. Fintest — HSBC (upd May 2024; Job Sim = HireVue; calculator allowed) — <https://www.fintest.io/employers/hsbc/>
- 33. Intervyo — Cappfinity Immersive Assessment guide (2026; blended profile, consistency scored) — <https://www.intervyo.co.uk/assessments/cappfinity>
- 34. Intervyo — Can you retake an online assessment (upd Jun 2026; 6–12-mo generic) — <https://www.intervyo.co.uk/answers/online-assessment/can-you-retake-an-online-assessment>
- 35. CareerTestPrep — HSBC Online Assessment guide (2026; norm group, ~3% offer, retake-next-cycle) — <https://www.careertestprep.com/blog/hsbc-online-assessment-guide>
- 36. Prepterminal — HSBC assessments course (upd Jul 2026; \$68/90 days; SHL/Hogan) — <https://www.prepterminal.com/courses/hsbc-assessments>
- 37. **OUTLIER** — **treat with caution** Aptitude-Test-Prep — HSBC Values Assessment (upd Apr 2026; describes OPQ32/SHL, methodology mismatch) — <https://aptitude-test-prep.com/employers/finance-and-investment-banking-assessments/hsbc-values-assessment/>
- 38. Built In — HSBC culture & values (2026; corroborates the four current values) — <https://builtin.com/company/hsbc-bank/faq/culture-values>
- 39. High5 — Cappfinity Strengths Test overview (strengths quadrant) — <https://high5test.com/cappfinity-strengths-test/>

Tier 3 — General reference (mechanism, not HSBC-specific)

- 40. US OPM — Situational Judgement Tests — <https://www.opm.gov/policy-data-oversight/assessment-and-selection/other-assessment-methods/situational-judgment-tests/>
- 41. University of Manchester Careers — SJTs — <https://www.careers.manchester.ac.uk/applicationsinterviews/psychometric/sjt/>

Tier 4 — Genuine candidate voice (gated; snippet-only or unopened)

- 42. Glassdoor — HSBC interview questions hub (login-gated; one snippet recovered, QTN_6902278) — <https://www.glassdoor.com/Interview/HSBC-Interview-Questions-E3482.htm>
- 43. The Student Room — "Hsbc immersive test" t=5603334 (~2019, snippet only; possibly obsolete) — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=5603334>
- 44. The Student Room — "HSBC Job Simulation 2021" t=6707088 (403, unopened) — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=6707088>
- 45. The Student Room — "HSBC Job Simulation" t=6156362 (403, unopened) — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=6156362>
- 46. The Student Room — "HSBC online immersive assessment" t=6709852 (403, unopened) — <https://www.thestudentroom.co.uk/showthread.php?t=6709852>

47. Wall Street Oasis — "HSBC Job Simulation" (403/login, unopened) — <https://www.wallstreetoasis.com/forum/investment-banking/hsbc-job-simulation>
48. YouTube — "2025 HSBC Online Immersive Assessment, Job Simulation... Exact Questions" (captcha-blocked, unopened) — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9zthcTo0Xbg>
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Compiled 8 August 2026 from the sources above. Reliability labels reflect the state of evidence at that date; HSBC's process changes frequently, so re-verify stage names and timings against your own invitation email and the pre-assessment instructions.

Self-contained briefing · rendered from `hsbc-assessment-briefing.md` · 8 August 2026. Reliability labels reflect the evidence at that date; HSBC's process changes frequently.